Till Arne Meissner

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Summary

Researcher and policy analyst with 7+ years of experience at the intersection of economic development, geospatial analysis, and quantitative impact evaluation.

- 5+ years of experience in research, advisory, and project management in international development cooperation, contributing to entrepreneurship, private sector development, and diaspora finance initiatives across Europe and Sub-Saharan Africa.
- 5+ years of hands-on work with technical writing, data visualisation, geospatial analysis, satellite data, and econometrics to inform local development strategies, policy design, and impact evaluation.

Fluent in German, English, and French, with strong technical skills in R, STATA, Google Earth Engine.

Education

PhD in Economic Geography Sep 2020 – Sep 2025
London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE) London, UK

- DTP scholarship from the Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC).
- PhD Dissertation title: "**Global Value Chains and Economic Development**".
- Conducted original research on the local impacts of global value chains, combining **firm-level, household, geospatial,** and **satellite data**, analysed using **advanced statistical** and **econometric methods.**

MSc Local Economic Development Sep 2018 - Sep 2019
London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE) London, UK

- Grade: Distinction.
- Winner of the MSc Local Economic Development Best Overall Performance Prize.

BA Philosophy & Economics Oct 2012 - Sep 2017
University of Bayreuth Bayreuth, Germany

- Erasmus Exchange Semester at Université Paris 1 Sorbonne (France).
- Global Exchange Semester at Kangwon National University (Republic of Korea).

Professional Experience

Graduate Research & Teaching Assistant Sep 2021 - Jun 2025
London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE) London, UK

Graduate Research Assistant: Research Assistance for the Structural Transformation and Economic Growth (STEG) research project entitled "Migration in the Face of Climate Change: Assessing the Potential of Ultra-Poor Graduation Programs"

- Collected and processed climate datasets using R and Google Earth Engine and linking them to household survey data from Upper Egypt.
- Conducted descriptive and econometric analyses on agricultural households' adaptation strategies to climate change.

Graduate Teaching Assistant: Planned, assisted, and presented practical seminars and lectures on:

- **Contemporary Europe (GY 103):** A course on the economics and politics of European integration (**LSE Class Teacher Awards in 2022, 2024 and 2025**).
- **Introduction to Geographical Research (GY 140):** A course introducing students to core statistical concepts, research methodologies and statistical software (R & STATA).

Senior Associate - Research Analyst & Business Operations Nov 2020 - Dec 2022
Scio Network GmbH & Co KG Frankfurt, Germany

- Led the conception, research and drafting of **a feasibility study on rigorous impact evaluations for the GIZ Programme "*Migration and Diaspora*"** (https://www.giz.de/en/downloads/giz2022-en-programme-migration-and-diaspora.pdf).
- Conducted **data analysis and project management for the GIZ Results Measurement Project**
- Developed and authored the "Collaborative Innovation – Toolkit for Startups".

Consultant - Private Sector Development Sep 2019 - Sep 2020
GFA Consulting Group GmbH Hamburg, Germany

- Led the successful acquisition of the EUR 519,512 GIZ-funded project **"Special Initiative Jobs – Upgrading the Textile and Garment Supply Chain"** in Ethiopia, including the preparation of the full technical and financial proposal.
- Contributed to bids for development cooperation tenders in the areas of **private sector development**, **business environment reform**, **trade facilitation**, and **quality infrastructure**, commissioned by bilateral and multilateral donors (e.g. GIZ, EU, World Bank).
- Managed the implementation of the EU-funded project **"Assistance to the SADC Trade Related Facility (TRF)"** (contract value: EUR 6.1 million), supporting the **Southern African Development Community (SADC)** in strengthening the implementation of international trade agreements, harmonising technical standards, and reducing non-tariff barriers to facilitate economic integration.

Intern & Consultant - Economic Policy and Enterprise Development Oct 2017 - May 2019
Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH Eschborn, Germany

Supported **project management, research, and advisory services** for GIZ's Section for Economic Policy and Enterprise Development, with a focus on **entrepreneurship promotion, industrial parks**, **macroeconomic reforms**, and **digital development (ICT4D).**

- Contributed to the design and early implementation of **WIDU**, **a digital platform to leverage diaspora remittances** for **business financing** in Cameroon and Ghana (see https://widu.africa/).
- Supported project coordination and advisory work for **women's entrepreneurship support initiatives** under GIZ's Women's Economic Empowerment programme in India.

Intern - Research Analyst & Policy Advisory Sep 2016 - Dec 2016
African Center for Economic Transformation(ACET) Accra, Ghana

Conducted research and supported policy advisory work within ACET's Policy Advisory section, contributing to a consultancy project on China's engagement in African development.

- Supported analysis on **China's role in Africa** with a focus on trade, finance, and ODA
- Applied ACET's **African Transformation Index (ATI) methodology** to assess economic transformation across 30 African economies for the **African Transformation Report 2017**

Languages and Technical Skills

Languages: English (fluent, TOEFL:114/120), French (fluent, C1), German (native), Spanish (basic, B1)
Software: Microsoft Office, QGIS, ArcGIS
Programming Languages/Tools: R, STATA, Google Earth Engine